winter, had worn their winter boots and could choose to use the wooden shoes only indoors to go to the washroom.

Rose and Léa squeezed between the women at the zinc trough. Though it extended nearly the length of the wall, there were only three faucets for forty women. Rose could feel the women's sharp elbows digging into her sides. Ignoring them, she inched closer and splashed cold water on her face. Bodies jostled from behind. She had to stand firm, bracing her hips against the trough long enough to rinse her face and brush her teeth.

After finishing at the wash trough, Rose queued for the next room, where toilets lined two sides of the walls with no doors or paneling for privacy. She was grateful that the single bulb from the ceiling flickered and dimmed, the light insufficient for the women to see one another.

Rose and Léa made their way to the canteen. Breakfast was a slice of bread with margarine and *muze*—a soup of fat-free milk sprinkled with dark bread flour. Yesterday, when Lagerführer Klein had given the sisters half their monthly salary upfront, she told them about the coffee they could buy in the canteen at the Archimedes factory for five *pfennigs*. Rose had carefully put the coins in the inner pouch of her apron in anticipation.

The smell of roasting coffee brought back happy memories of early mornings in the kitchen with her mother, smelling the nutty, caramel aroma as Maman turned the wooden handle, grinding the beans before setting the coffee on the stove. Her mother loved dipping a crisp croissant into the dark liquid; she had always said it was the simple pleasures we should never take for granted, like the flaky interior of a croissant drenched in coffee. Under the Occupation, buying coffee was nearly impossible, except on the black market, so it had been two years since she'd had any.

Outside, the sky was stone gray, though ripples of pink, orange and yellow edged the clouds. Something fragile and bright stirred inside her, a reminder of hope. Rose wished she had her sketchpad and pencil. Léa had told her not to bring them to the factory, but Rose felt incomplete without a sketchpad in her pocket.

"You'll be working in a factory with machines and must pay attention," Léa warned. "You can draw when you're back at the barracks."

Rose didn't want to draw at the barracks. She preferred being outside under the sky, among the stream, clouds, and trees. André would understand. Sometimes, she felt he was the only person in the world who